

Shopez E-Commerce

Backend Server Setup & Initialization

This document outlines the initial steps required to set up the backend server environment for the Shoppez application, establishing the foundational file and folder structure.

Phase 1: Project Initialization

1. Open Terminal and Initialize npm

First, navigate to your dedicated Server folder within VSCode and open the integrated terminal. Run the following command to initialize a new Node.js project:

```
npm init -y
```

Explanation: The `-y` flag automatically answers "yes" to all setup prompts, instantly generating a default `package.json` file. This file will keep track of all your project dependencies (like Express, Mongoose, etc.) and custom scripts.

Phase 2: File & Folder Structure

2. Create the Entry File

In the root of your Server folder, create the main entry point file for the application:

- **server.js**: This file will contain the code to start your Express server, connect to the database, and configure global middleware.

3. Create Architectural Folders

To keep the application organized and scalable, create the following directories to implement an MVC (Model-View-Controller) pattern:

- **models/**: Will store Mongoose schemas that define the structure of your MongoDB collections (e.g., User, Product, Order).
- **controllers/**: Will contain the core business logic. Functions here will process incoming requests, interact with the models, and send responses back to the client.
- **routes/**: Will define the API endpoints (URLs) and map them to the corresponding controller functions.

Setup complete. The server architecture is now ready for dependency installation and routing configuration.